

MILESTONE

1. Passage anchor

> “She gave it to me because she wanted to celebrate that small ****milestone**** in my life.”

Passage meaning

****milestone**** = an important event or stage that marks significant progress or change

****里程碑；重要階段；重要節點****

Here, finishing the final exams marks a meaningful transition in the speaker's life.

Practice

1. Finishing university was a major ****milestone**** for her.

大學畢業是她人生中的一個重要****里程碑****。

2. Moving into my first home felt like a real ****milestone****.

搬進第一個自己的家，讓我覺得是真正的人生****重要節點****。

Core meanings of MILESTONE

2. milestone — literal roadside marker

= a stone or marker showing the distance to a place, traditionally measured in miles

****里程碑；英里標誌****

Examples

1. An old stone ****milestone**** stood beside the road.

路邊立著一塊古老的****里程碑****。

2. The ****milestone**** showed that the town was five miles away.

那塊****里程標誌****顯示城鎮還有五英里。

This is the original literal sense.

Figurative: important stage

3. milestone — important stage in development

= a significant point in the progress or development of a person, project, organization, etc.

****里程碑；重要階段****

This is the exact passage sense.

Examples

1. Learning to drive was an important ****milestone****.

學會駕駛是一個重要的****人生里程碑****。

2. The company reached a major ****milestone**** this year.

公司今年達到了一個重大****里程碑****。

4. personal milestone

= important event in a person's life

****人生里程碑；個人重要階段****

Examples

1. Graduation is a major ****personal milestone****.

畢業是一個重要的****人生里程碑****。

2. Her first job was another ****personal milestone****.

她的第一份工作是另一個****人生重要節點****。

5. developmental milestone

= important stage in physical, cognitive, emotional, or social development

****發展里程碑；成長階段指標****

Examples

1. Walking is an important ****developmental milestone**** for a child.

學會走路是孩子重要的****發展里程碑****。

2. Doctors monitor key ****developmental milestones****.

醫生會觀察關鍵的****成長發展指標****。

High-value education/health sense.

Project / business use

6. milestone — project checkpoint

= important stage, deliverable, or checkpoint in a project

****專案里程碑；關鍵節點****

Examples

1. Completing the prototype was a major project ****milestone****.

完成原型是一個重要的專案****里程碑****。

2. The team reached its first ****milestone**** on schedule.

團隊按時達成了第一個****關鍵節點****。

7. project milestone

= predefined point used to measure project progress

****專案里程碑；階段性目標****

Examples

1. Each ****project milestone**** has a target date.

每個****專案里程碑****都有目標日期。

2. The next ****milestone**** is final testing.

下一個****階段性目標****是最終測試。

Achievement / record

8. milestone achievement

= achievement that marks major progress or importance

****里程碑式成就；重大成就****

Examples

1. The discovery was a ****milestone achievement**** in the field.

那項發現是該領域的****里程碑式成就****。

2. Reaching one million users was a major ****milestone achievement****.

達到一百萬名用戶是一項重大**里程碑成就**。

Time / anniversary

9. milestone birthday / anniversary

= age or anniversary regarded as especially significant

重要生日；重要週年紀念

Typical examples include ages such as 18, 21, 50, etc., depending on culture and context.

Examples

1. She celebrated her fiftieth as a **milestone birthday**.
她把五十歲生日作為一個**重要生日里程碑**來慶祝。
2. Their tenth anniversary was a **milestone anniversary**.
他們十週年是一個重要的**週年里程碑**。

Reaching progress points

10. reach a milestone

= arrive at an important stage or achievement

達到一個里程碑；達成重要階段

Examples

1. The project has **reached an important milestone**.
專案已經**達到一個重要里程碑**。
2. She **reached a major milestone** in her career.
她在職業生涯中**達成了一個重要里程碑**。

Very common collocation.

11. mark a milestone

= represent or celebrate an important stage

標誌一個里程碑；紀念重要階段

Examples

1. The ceremony **marked a major milestone**.
這個儀式**標誌著一個重要里程碑**。
2. The launch **marks a milestone** for the company.
這次推出產品**標誌著公司的重要階段**。

Small milestone

12. small milestone

= modest but meaningful point of progress

小里程碑；小小的重要進展

This is the passage wording.

Examples

1. Passing the exam felt like a **small milestone**.
通過考試感覺像是一個**小小的里程碑**。
2. Even a **small milestone** can feel meaningful.
即使是一個**小進展**，也可能很有意義。

Related forms / collocations

13. milestone event

= event that represents a major turning point or achievement

里程碑事件

Examples

1. The signing was a **milestone event** in the negotiations.
簽署協議是談判中的一個**里程碑事件**。
2. The invention became a **milestone event** in modern technology.
這項發明成為現代科技的一個**里程碑事件**。

14. milestone moment

= moment that marks major progress or change

****里程碑時刻；重要時刻****

Examples

1. It was a ****milestone moment**** in her career.

那是她職業生涯中的一個****里程碑時刻****。

2. Winning the award was a ****milestone moment**** for the team.

獲獎是團隊的一個****重要時刻****。

Key contrasts

15. milestone vs achievement

****achievement****

= something successfully accomplished

****成就****

****milestone****

= important point marking progress or transition

****里程碑****

Compare:

> Winning the award was an ****achievement****.

> 獲獎是一項成就。

> Winning the award was a ****milestone**** in her career.

> 獲獎是她職業生涯中的一個里程碑。

An achievement can be a milestone, but not every achievement is one.

16. milestone vs goal

****goal****

= something you aim to achieve in the future

****目標****

****milestone****

= important checkpoint or stage on the way to a broader goal

****里程碑；階段性節點****

Compare:

> Goal: launch the product.

> 目標：推出產品。

> Milestone: complete final testing.

> 里程碑：完成最終測試。

17. milestone vs turning point

****turning point****

= moment when a situation changes direction significantly

****轉捩點****

****milestone****

= important stage showing progress or significance

****里程碑****

A turning point emphasizes ****change of direction****; a milestone emphasizes ****progress or significance****.

18. milestone vs landmark

****landmark****

can mean:

1. famous physical place/building

2. major historical achievement/event

****milestone****

focuses more specifically on progress through stages.

Compare:

> a landmark decision

> 具有重大歷史意義的決定

> a milestone in the project

> 專案進程中的重要里程碑

19. milestone vs checkpoint

checkpoint

= point where progress is checked or verified

檢查點；檢核點

milestone

= important stage itself, often used to measure progress

里程碑

A checkpoint can be routine; a milestone usually has greater significance.

Meaning map

The original literal idea is:

a physical marker showing how far along a road you have travelled

That develops naturally into the figurative meaning:

an important marker showing how far you have progressed in life, work, development, or a project

Literal

road milestone

→ **里程標誌**

Personal life

personal milestone

→ **人生里程碑**

Development

developmental milestone

→ **成長里程碑**

Project

project milestone

→ ****關鍵節點 / 階段性目標****

Career/business

major milestone

→ ****重大進展****

Celebration

milestone birthday

→ ****重要生日****

The passage uses the personal-progress branch:

> ****that small milestone in my life****

> → ****我人生中的一個小小里程碑****

MCQ-ready master list

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
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milestone — literal	道路旁顯示距離的石碑 / 里程標誌
milestone — figurative progress	標誌重要進展、發展或改變的事件 / 階段；里程碑
personal milestone	一個人生命中具有重要意義的階段或事件；人生里程碑
developmental milestone	身體、認知、情緒或社交發展中的重要階段指標
project milestone	用來衡量專案進展的重要階段 / 關鍵節點
milestone achievement	標誌重大進步或意義的成就；里程碑式成就
milestone birthday/anniversary	被視為特別重要的生日 / 週年紀念
reach a milestone	達到一個重要發展階段或成就
mark a milestone	標誌或紀念一個重要階段
small milestone	規模不大但仍有意義的重要進展
milestone event	具有重大階段性意義的事件
milestone moment	標誌重大進展或改變的重要時刻

Passage recap

> “...she wanted to celebrate that small ****milestone**** in my life.”

Here:

****milestone**** = ****an important event or stage marking progress or change in someone's life****

Best Traditional Chinese:

* ****里程碑****

* ****重要階段****

* ****重要節點****

Natural contextual translation:

****她想為我人生中的一個小里程碑慶祝一下。****

Passage MCQ-ready meaning

****milestone****

= ****an important event or stage that marks significant progress or development****

****里程碑；重要階段****

The core metaphor is:

> literal road milestone

> → 標示走了多遠

and:

> figurative life milestone

> → 標示人生走到哪個重要階段

In the passage, finishing the important exams is not necessarily the speaker's biggest achievement ever, but it is still a meaningful ****small milestone**** because it closes one stage and points toward the next.